

Step-by-Step Deployment Guide - Host2Unlimited CMS

This guide details the step-by-step instructions for configuring the database on **Supabase** (PostgreSQL) and deploying both the backend and frontend services on **Render**.

Pre-requisites Checklist

- ☐ A GitHub repository containing your project code.
- ☐ A free account on [Supabase](https://supabase.com).
- ☐ A free account on [Render](https://render.com).

Step 1: Configure Supabase Database

1. Log In / Create Project:

- ✦ Go to supabase.com and log in.
- ✦ Click **New Project** and choose your organization.
- ✦ Set a name (e.g., `Host2Unlimited-CMS`) and enter a **Database Password** (write this password down!).
- ✦ Choose the region closest to you (e.g., `Singapore` or `Mumbai`) and click **Create new project**.
- ✦ Wait 1-2 minutes for the database to provision.

2. Get the Session Pooler Connection String:

> [!IMPORTANT]

> Do **NOT** use the direct connection string. Render requires the IPv4 Connection Pooler in **Session** mode to work.

- ✦ Look at the top header bar of your project dashboard and click the **Connect** button.
- ✦ In the popup window, click on the **Connection Pooler** tab.
- ✦ Set **Mode** to **Session** (this runs on port `5432` and uses IPv4 routing).

- ✦ Under the **URI** text box, copy the connection string. It will look like this:

```
postgresql://postgres.kvgbphopauybvvgkhtudh:my_secure_db_password@aws-0-ap-northeast-1.pooler.supabase.com:5432/postgres
```

- ✦ **Crucial:** Replace `my_secure_db_password` with your actual database password in the connection string.

Step 2: Deploy Backend to Render

1. Log in to render.com.
2. Click **New + at the top right** and select **Web Service**.
3. Link your GitHub repository.
4. Configure the settings:

- ✦ **Name:** `host2unlimited-backend`
- ✦ **Language:** `Node`
- ✦ **Root Directory:** `backend`
- ✦ **Build Command:** `npm install`
- ✦ **Start Command:** `node server.js`
- ✦ **Instance Type:** Select **Free**.

5. Click **Advanced > Add Environment Variable** and enter the following settings:

Key	Example / Value	Description & How to Find It
PORT	5050	The network port the server listens on. Enter <code>5050</code> matching your configuration.
DATABASE_URL	postgresql://postgres.kvgbphopauybvvgkhtudh:my_secure_db_password@aws-0-ap-northeast-1.pooler.supabase.com:5432/postgres	Your Supabase Connection Pooler URI (copied from Step 1).
JWT_SECRET	supersecretkey1234567890abcdef	A secure random string. You can type any random letters and numbers.

NODE_
ENV

production

Tells Node.js and Express to run in optimized production mode. Type `production`.

6. Click **Create Web Service**.

7. Wait for the build logs to show success. Copy the Web Service URL from the top left of the page (e.g., `https://host2unlimited-backend.onrender.com`).



Step 3: Deploy Frontend to Render

1. On your Render Dashboard, click **New +** and select **Static Site**.

2. Link your GitHub repository.

3. Configure the settings:

◆ **Name:** `host2unlimited-frontend`

◆ **Root Directory:** `frontend`

◆ **Build Command:** `npm run build`

◆ **Publish Directory:** `dist`

4. Click **Advanced > Add Environment Variable**:

Key	Example / Value	Description & How to Find It
<code>VITE_API_URL</code>	<code>https://host2unlimited-backend.onrender.com</code>	Paste the Render Web Service URL you copied from your Backend service page in Step 2 .

5. Click **Create Static Site**.



Step 4: Local vs Live Switching (Optional)

If you want to view or edit the live Supabase database content locally from your computer:

1. Open the `[backend/.env](file:///e:/Freelancing/Host2Unlimited/backend/.env)` file.

2. Paste your Supabase connection URI in `DATABASE_URL`.

3. Set `FORCE_LIVE_DB=true`.

4. Run `npm run dev` locally.

Where to Add Credentials (File Paths & Locations)

1. For Local Development (Running on your computer)

- Backend Configuration:

- ✦ **File Path:** `backend/.env` (located in [backend/.env]
(file:///e:/Freelancing/Host2Unlimited/backend/.env))
- ✦ **Variable to set:** `DATABASE_URL="postgresql://postgres.kvgbphopauybvgtudh:my_secure_db_password@aws-0-ap-northeast-1.pooler.supabase.com:5432/postgres"` (if using Supabase locally) and ensure `FORCE_LIVE_DB=true` .

- Frontend Configuration:

- ✦ **File Path:** `frontend/.env` (located in [frontend/.env]
(file:///e:/Freelancing/Host2Unlimited/frontend/.env))
- ✦ **Variable to set:** `VITE_API_URL=http://localhost:5050` (points to your local backend server).

2. For Live Production (Deployed on Render)

- Backend Web Service Configuration:

- ✦ **Location:** Your Render Dashboard > Select your **Backend Web Service** > **Environment Variables** tab.
- ✦ **Variables to add:**
- ✦ `PORT` = `5050`
- ✦ `DATABASE_URL` = `postgresql://postgres.kvgbphopauybvgtudh:my_secure_db_password@aws-0-ap-northeast-1.pooler.supabase.com:5432/postgres`
- ✦ `JWT_SECRET` = `supersecretkey1234567890abcdef`
- ✦ `NODE_ENV` = `production`

- Frontend Static Site Configuration:

- ✦ **Location:** Your Render Dashboard > Select your **Frontend Static Site** > **Environment Variables** tab.
- ✦ **Variable to add:**
- ✦ `VITE_API_URL` = `https://host2unlimited-backend.onrender.com`

3. Render Redirects/Rewrites Rule (For React Router / Sub-page Refreshes)

To prevent **404 Not Found** errors when refreshing sub-pages (like **/admin** or **/services**) on your live website:

- **Location:** Your Render Dashboard > Select your **Frontend Static Site** > **Redirects/Rewrites** tab.

- **Rule to add:**

✦ **Source:** **/***

✦ **Destination:** **/index.html**

✦ **Action:** **Rewrite**

- **Save:** Click **Save Changes**. This forwards all route requests to your React index page, allowing React Router to display sub-routes correctly.